

June 3, 2026 BOS Meeting 7pm Burrows Run Rd

Good evening, Chair Muller and members of the Board.

My name is Monica Strauser, and I am a Kennett Township resident. "I am requesting that the substance of my comments be recorded in the official minutes. I have provided a copy of my remarks to the secretary and request they be included in or attached to the minutes"

I want to begin by saying clearly that I support our police department, and I support fixing the deficiencies in the current facility.

But tonight I want to speak about something bigger than a building. I want to speak about strategic planning in local government.

Strategic planning is one of the core responsibilities of a governing body. It means starting with facts: where we are today, where we expect to be in five or ten years, what services we intend to provide, what staffing and equipment will be required, and what taxpayers can responsibly afford.

A strategic plan is not just a document. It is a decision-making tool. It should shape budgets, staffing, infrastructure, and future growth. Major capital projects should come after that work, not before it.

That is my concern with the proposed police building.

A feasibility study is not a strategic plan. A feasibility study can identify facility problems, examine options for more space, and estimate costs. But at least in what has been made public, it does not show a policing strategic plan, population and tax-base growth forecasts, or workload trend analysis that justifies this specific building and this specific size.

From what has been made public, this process appears to have started with a facility problem and moved quickly to a building solution. The study says, in effect, we need more space, and then asks how we can get more space. But the missing question is: how much space do we actually need, based on a public policing plan, growth projections, workload trends, and financial capacity?

That is the missing foundation.

Where is the public five-year or ten-year policing strategic plan?

What staffing levels are assumed in years one, five, and ten?

What coverage model is this building designed for: the current model, or a future 24/7 local model?

Where are the population projections, household projections, zoning build-out projections, and tax-base forecasts?

Where is the analysis of historical police activity, and how that activity is expected to change as Kennett Township grows?

And where is the room-by-room explanation showing which spaces are required, which are best practice, which are preferred, and which are reserve capacity for the future?

These are not hostile questions. They are due-diligence questions. They are the questions the Board should be asking staff and consultants before committing taxpayers to a project of this scope.

To be clear, I am not arguing that nothing should be done. Improvements are needed. But proving that the current space is inadequate is not the same as proving that this proposed building is the correct solution.

Much has been made of the fact that the current Township building, built in 2003, no longer meets our needs. I see that as a warning. If this building failed to anticipate future needs, then we should not repeat the same mistake by approving another building without a clear, public, data-driven plan.

The Board has been shown concepts, cost estimates, and a preferred option. But I do not believe the Board, or the public, has been given all the facts needed to make this decision responsibly.

When analysis is missing, it creates the appearance that the decision came first and the facts are being assembled afterward. That damages public trust. The way to restore trust is to show the assumptions, the alternatives, and the calculations.

Before moving forward, I ask the Board to request additional analysis and present it to residents: A public policing strategic plan, population and tax-base projections, long-term operating cost projections, a true minimum “must-have” option, a current-staffing-only option, and a phased alternative.

If this building is the right answer, the data should prove it.

But until that work is done and made public, any decision to move the project forward or raise our taxes, is premature.

Thank you.